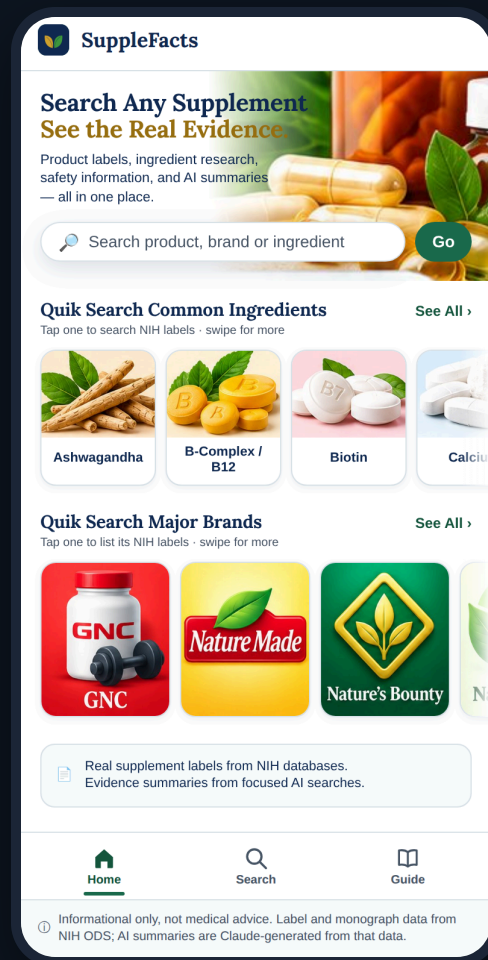


# How to Use SuppleFacts

A phone guide to searching real supplement labels, getting an AI summary of every ingredient, and running a deeper evidence check with Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity.

CHECK THE EVIDENCE · MAKE INFORMED CHOICES



# What This Guide Covers

SuppleFacts puts the NIH's database of real supplement labels in your pocket. Search a product, see exactly what is on its label, then check the evidence behind every ingredient. This guide shows you how, one screen at a time, with plain steps for the two evidence buttons and for using the AI apps on your phone.

The app is independent. No sponsor pays for it, and nothing in it replaces a conversation with your own doctor or pharmacist. SuppleFacts is built to help you ask better questions of both.

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# About SuppleFacts

SuppleFacts is the phone companion to The American Supplement Investigation, the website and three-book series by Robert Coleman, MS Pharm., and Joy Meier, Pharm.D. It puts the site's core idea, *check the evidence before you buy*, in your pocket.

## What it does

- **Searches real labels.** Every search runs live against the NIH Office of Dietary Supplements' Dietary Supplement Label Database (DSLD), which holds over 200,000 U.S. product labels as submitted by manufacturers.
- **Shows the label clearly.** Brand, product, serving size, every declared ingredient and its amount, other ingredients, and label claims.
- **Explains the ingredients.** Curated ingredient guides (monographs) in plain language or clinical detail, plus a live AI Ingredient Summary written by Claude for the exact product you open.
- **Goes deeper on request.** One tap sends the whole label and a research prompt to the AI of your choice, so you can check doses and compare studies.

## Where the information comes from

SuppleFacts keeps no product database of its own. The NIH stays the source of truth for what is on a label, and the app's job is connecting that label to the evidence. The AI features are research helpers, not authorities.

## Put it on your Home Screen

SuppleFacts is a web app, so there is nothing to download from an app store. Add it to your Home Screen once and it opens full screen like any other app. The address is **[supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html](https://supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html)**.

### IPHONE (SAFARI)

- Open the SuppleFacts address in Safari.
- Tap the **Share** button (square with an arrow).
- Scroll and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**. The SuppleFacts leaf icon (navy square, gold and green leaves) is now on your Home Screen.

### ANDROID (CHROME)

- Open the same address in Chrome.
- Tap the **three-dot menu** at the top right.
- Tap **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**, then confirm.

### TIP

The app shows a short reminder card with these steps the first time you open it on a phone; tap the X to dismiss it. If the app ever looks out of date after an update, close and reopen it. Removing the Home Screen icon and adding it again always fetches the latest version.

# Finding a Supplement

Everything starts on the Home screen. You can type a search or tap a Quik Search tile. Both do the same thing: ask the NIH label database.

## 1 Type in the search box

Enter a product, a brand, or an ingredient, then tap **Go**. Adding the brand narrows things quickly: "Nature Made Vitamin D3" finds your product faster than "vitamin D" alone.

## 2 Or tap a Quik Search tile

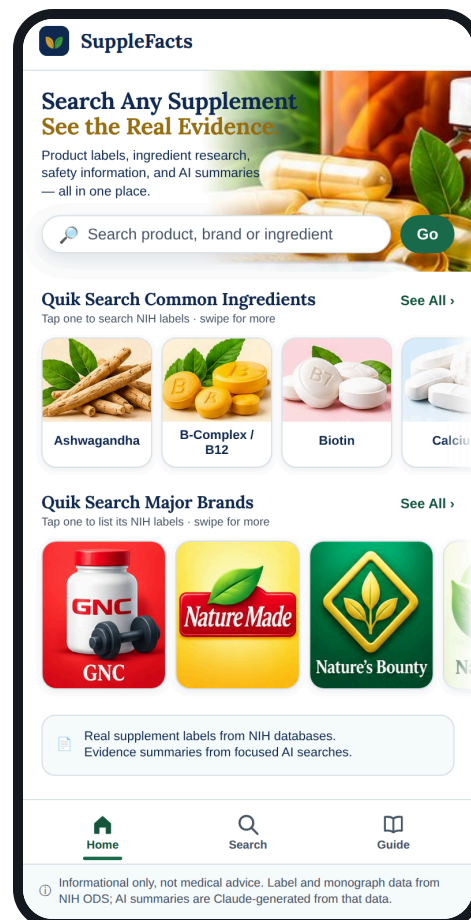
**Quik Search Common Ingredients** lists 25 of the most common supplement ingredients, in alphabetical order. **Quik Search Major Brands** lists well-known producers. Swipe either row sideways to see more, or tap **See All** to view them in a grid.

## 3 Pick your product from the results

Tap the product that matches the bottle in your hand. For some ingredients, an ingredient guide (monograph) appears with the product labels. Tap a card to open it.

## 4 Use Back to go back

The arrow at the top left always takes you one screen back. The **Home** tab returns you to the start, and the **Search** tab puts the cursor in the search box.



The Home screen: search box, Quik Search rows, and the three tabs.

### TIP

**Product not turning up?** Try the brand name alone, or drop a word such as "Complex" or "Advanced." NIH label records use the exact wording printed on the bottle, which does not always match how a product is marketed. The tiles show how the NIH records a brand name, so a brand tile may list a sub-brand separately.

### GOOD TO KNOW

Results come live from the NIH. If the NIH is busy or your signal is weak, you will see a message with a Try again button. Nothing is made up while you wait.

# Reading the Label Screen

Open any product and you see its NIH label record, followed by the two evidence buttons. The illustration shows a sample product.

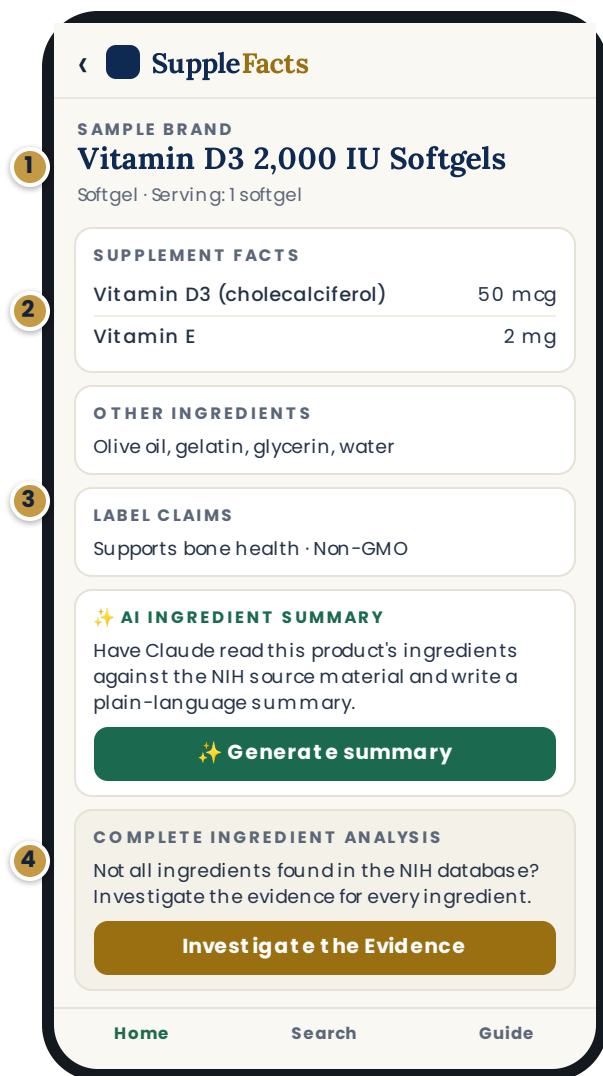


Illustration of a label screen. Your screen shows the real product.

- 1 Product details.** Brand, product name, form, and serving size, exactly as recorded in the NIH database.
- 2 Supplement Facts.** Each declared ingredient with its amount per serving and % Daily Value where the label lists one. Tap a row that says **View ingredient monograph** to read its guide. A row that says **Ask AI** has no guide in the app; tap it to investigate that one ingredient (see Part Three).
- 3 Other ingredients and label claims.** Fillers, binders, and capsule materials, plus the wording the manufacturer uses on the label. Claims appear as chips; they are the maker's statements, not findings.
- 4 The two evidence buttons.** **Generate summary** (green) gives you a quick read inside the app. **Investigate the Evidence** (gold) sends the full label to a research assistant of your choice. The next two pages cover each one.

## LOOK FOR

- **Proprietary blends:** a total weight with no per-ingredient amounts. You cannot tell how much of each ingredient you are getting.
- **Missing % Daily Value:** some ingredients have no official daily target, so none is listed.
- **Dose units:** mcg, mg, IU. Many labels also put the amount "per serving" while the bottle's directions say to take more than one.

The line under the label reads: "Shows what the manufacturer declares — not contaminant testing." A label tells you what a maker says is in the bottle. It does not tell you whether the product was tested.

# AI Ingredient Summary

The green **Generate summary** button gives you a fast, plain-language read on the product you are looking at. It is the quickest of the two evidence buttons and it stays inside the app.

## 1 Open a product, then scroll to the AI Ingredient Summary panel

It sits just under the label, above the gold Investigate button.

## 2 Tap "Generate summary"

The panel shows "Asking Claude..." and then "Writing..." while the answer builds. It usually takes a few seconds. The app sends Claude only this product's label information (ingredients, amounts, serving, form, and claims), not anything about you.

## 3 Read the summary

You get plain paragraphs: what the main ingredients are, what the research says about them, anything worth watching for, and how the product's makeup compares with what the evidence supports. The panel notes that it was generated by Claude and is not medical advice.

## 4 Tap "Regenerate" for a fresh version

If you open the same product again later, the saved summary appears right away. Tap **Regenerate** if you want Claude to write a new one.

### WHAT THE SUMMARY IS GOOD FOR

- A quick orientation before you decide whether a product deserves a closer look.
- Translating a long ingredient list into everyday language.
- Spotting ingredients you want to ask your pharmacist or doctor about.

### WHAT IT IS NOT

- It is a starting point written by AI, not a verdict. Treat every claim as something to verify.
- It reads only what is on this label. It does not know your medicines, your health conditions, or the product's lab testing.
- For a full dose-by-dose comparison with published studies, use the second button (next page).

### IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

"Claude is busy right now" means too many requests arrived at once; wait a moment and tap **Try again**. If a message says the live summary is not switched on, the app offers a **Full analysis on the website** button that opens the second option instead.

# Investigate the Evidence

The gold **Investigate the Evidence** button goes beyond the label. It builds a research prompt from this exact product, then hands it to the AI assistant you choose: Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity.

## 1 Tap "Investigate the Evidence"

It is the gold button at the bottom of the product screen, under "Complete ingredient analysis." The app opens the Product Lookup page of The American Supplement Investigation in a new tab, with your whole label already loaded in a research prompt.

## 2 Look over the prompt (optional)

The prompt appears in a box so you can see what will be sent. It asks the AI to explain each ingredient, summarize the evidence, flag safety concerns and interactions, and note where evidence is weak or missing.

## 3 Choose where to run it

Tap **Analyze with Claude**, **Analyze with ChatGPT**, or **Analyze with Perplexity** to open that assistant with your prompt, or tap **Copy Full Research Prompt** to paste it into any AI you like, including Gemini.

## 4 Read the answer, then check its sources

A good answer compares the dose with what studies used and names safety issues. Treat every citation as a starting point and confirm it says what the AI claims.

## Just one ingredient? Tap "Ask AI" on its row

A row marked **Ask AI** has no guide in the app. Tap it for a screen with that ingredient's own **Investigate the Evidence** button, then tap **Back to the original label** to return to the same spot.

## Optional: add a photo of the label

The screen has a box that says **Paste label image URL (optional)**. If you paste the web address of a photo of the label, the button opens the lookup page with that image instead of the standard prompt. Leave it blank for the normal prompt.

## Which button should I use?

|                      | GENERATE SUMMARY            | INVESTIGATE THE EVIDENCE                                      |
|----------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Speed</b>         | Seconds, stays in the app   | Opens another page and an AI app                              |
| <b>Best for</b>      | A first look at one product | Checking doses, comparing studies, asking follow-up questions |
| <b>Who writes it</b> | Claude, through SuppleFacts | The assistant you pick, on your account                       |
| <b>Account</b>       | None needed                 | Your own account with the AI app you choose                   |

SuppleFacts does not see your chat with Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity. Once the prompt is sent, you are using that company's app under your own account and privacy terms.

# Setting Up Claude, ChatGPT & Perplexity

All three assistants work in your phone's web browser and also have their own apps. Each requires an account, and plans and usage limits change over time. Sign in once, ahead of time, so the evidence check runs smoothly the first time.

## Claude

by Anthropic

1. Search **Claude** in the App Store or Google Play and install the app from **Anthropic** (or just use [claude.ai](https://claude.ai) in your browser).
2. Open it and sign in or create an account with your email or your Google or Apple account.
3. In SuppleFacts, tap **Analyze with Claude**. The full prompt is copied to your clipboard and Claude opens a **blank chat**.
4. Tap the message box, **press and hold** until the menu appears, tap **Paste**, then tap the send arrow.

## ChatGPT

by OpenAI

1. Search **ChatGPT** in the App Store or Google Play and install the app from **OpenAI** (or use [chatgpt.com](https://chatgpt.com) in your browser).
2. Sign in or create an account.
3. In SuppleFacts, tap **Analyze with ChatGPT**. ChatGPT opens with your prompt already in the message box.
4. Tap the send arrow. If the box is empty (this can happen with a very long label), the full prompt is on your clipboard: press and hold in the box, tap **Paste**, then send.

## Perplexity

by Perplexity AI

1. Search **Perplexity** in the App Store or Google Play and install it (or use [perplexity.ai](https://perplexity.ai) in your browser).
2. Sign in or create an account. Some answers work without one, but signing in lets you keep your searches.
3. In SuppleFacts, tap **Analyze with Perplexity**. Perplexity opens and **runs the search automatically**, with sources listed beside the answer.
4. If it opens without your prompt, the full prompt is on your clipboard. Press and hold in the search box, tap **Paste**, and send.

### GOOD TO KNOW

- **Browser or app?** Depending on your phone, the link opens in your browser or straight in the app. Both work, with the same steps.
- **Sign in first.** If you are not signed in when the page opens, sign in, tap Back, and run the analysis again.
- **Why Claude needs a paste.** Claude does not accept a ready-made prompt from a link, so SuppleFacts copies it and you paste it. ChatGPT and Perplexity can receive it directly.

App names, screens, and plan limits change. If a label on your phone looks different, look for the same idea: a new chat, a message box, and a send arrow.



## Questions to Ask Next

The research prompt starts the conversation. The real value comes from follow-up questions. Because the AI already has the exact product, ingredients, and doses, you can check doses and compare studies in the same chat. Copy any of these in.

### Check the doses

"For each ingredient in this product, compare the amount per serving with the doses used in published clinical trials. Where is this product's dose lower or higher than what the studies tested?"

"Is any ingredient at or above the tolerable upper intake level for adults? Give the source for that limit."

### Compare the studies

"Which ingredients here have strong evidence, which have moderate or limited evidence, and which have none? Rate each Strong / Moderate / Limited / No Benefit / Harm."

"Summarize the most recent systematic reviews and randomized trials on *[ingredient]* for *[reason you take it]*. What did they actually find?"

"Does the evidence differ for people who are not deficient in this nutrient?"

### Check the sources

"List every study or source you used with title, journal, year, and a link, so I can check them myself."

"What would change your answer? What evidence is still missing?"

### Bring your own situation

"Does this product interact with *[medicine you take]*?"

#### BEFORE YOU SHARE PERSONAL DETAILS

Naming your medicines makes the answer more useful, but it also puts that information into an AI company's system. Share only what you are comfortable sharing, and never your name, address, or account numbers.

#### ALWAYS VERIFY

AI assistants can misquote studies or invent citations that look real. Open the sources they list, and confirm anything about safety or interactions with your pharmacist or doctor.

# What the Label Can, and Can't, Tell You

SuppleFacts is not a database this site built or maintains. Every search runs live against the NIH Office of Dietary Supplements' Dietary Supplement Label Database (DSLD), a public, government-run record of what manufacturers have submitted. Keeping it that way is deliberate: the NIH stays the source of truth for what is on the label, and the app's job is connecting that label to the evidence.

## IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS

**Label data is manufacturer-reported.** A label in the database may be incomplete or out of date, and a product's presence is not an endorsement by the NIH, FDA, or HHS. It is a record of what a label says.

**The label is not a lab test.** It lists what the maker declares. It does not show whether the bottle contains what it says, or whether it is free of contaminants.

**The AI is a research assistant, not an authority.** Treat its analysis as a well-organized starting point. Verify anything important against the cited sources and with a pharmacist or physician.

**SuppleFacts does not replace medical advice.** It is built to help you ask better questions of your doctor or pharmacist, not to substitute for that conversation.

## Quick tips

- Brand tiles use the brand name as the NIH records it, so a company's separate sub-brands appear on their own.
- Labels change. A product you check today may be reformulated later, so search again before you re-buy.
- For a ranked look at America's best-selling supplements against the clinical evidence, see the Top 25 Supplements guide on the website. SuppleFacts shows you the label; the Top 25 guide adds the site's own evidence ratings for the most commonly searched ingredients.
- Printable help for your next appointment: the "What Are You Taking?" medication-and-supplement worksheet at the end of Book Two, *The Hollow Aisle*.

Data source: National Institutes of Health, Office of Dietary Supplements, Dietary Supplement Label Database (dslid.od.nih.gov). Public domain, CC0 1.0. Statements on supplement labels have not been evaluated by the FDA. Supplements are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.

# Every Feature, One Page

Keep this page handy.

| FEATURE                               | WHAT IT IS FOR                                                        | WHERE TO FIND IT              |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>Search box</b>                     | Search the NIH label database by product, brand, or ingredient        | Home tab, top                 |
| <b>Quik Search Common Ingredients</b> | One-tap searches for 25 common ingredients                            | Home tab, swipe or See All    |
| <b>Quik Search Major Brands</b>       | One-tap lists of labels from well-known brands                        | Home tab, swipe or See All    |
| <b>Label screen</b>                   | Brand, product, form, serving, ingredients and amounts, claims        | Tap any product               |
| <b>Ingredient guides</b>              | Plain-language and clinical-detail monographs                         | Tap an ingredient card        |
| <b>Generate summary</b>               | A quick plain-language read on one product, by Claude                 | Label screen, green button    |
| <b>Investigate the Evidence</b>       | Full label and research prompt sent to Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity | Label screen, gold button     |
| <b>Copy Full Research Prompt</b>      | Paste the same prompt into any AI assistant                           | Website page that opens       |
| <b>Guide tab</b>                      | This guide                                                            | Bottom bar, right             |
| <b>Product Lookup</b>                 | The website version, with the same prompt tools                       | /product-lookup               |
| <b>Top 25 Supplements</b>             | Best-sellers ranked against the clinical evidence                     | /top-25-supplements           |
| <b>FAQ and Evidence Library</b>       | Sourced answers and every citation                                    | /faq, /annotated-bibliography |

## If something doesn't work

- **No results:** shorten the search, try the brand alone, or check spelling.
- **"Couldn't reach the NIH":** tap Try again in a moment.
- **Summary won't generate:** wait and tap Try again, or use Investigate the Evidence.
- **Prompt missing in the AI app:** it is on your clipboard. Press and hold in the message box and tap Paste.
- **App looks out of date:** close and reopen it, or re-add the Home Screen icon.



## **Before You Take That Supplement, Check the Evidence.**

For patients, clinicians, and the public. Independent, with no industry sponsorship or advertising.

[supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html](https://supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html)

Questions or corrections: [outreach@brokenpromiseshealthcare.org](mailto:outreach@brokenpromiseshealthcare.org)

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